

Stop Re-Explaining Yourself

Building systems with AI – and teaching your students to
think with it

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github.com/parties/ai-workshop

**The description of this talk
was written in February.**

Much has changed since then.

What I promised you in February

*"You've used Claude or ChatGPT. Now build systems. This hands-on workshop takes you from asking questions to building repeatable workflows... We'll work through three real scenarios: **structuring effective prompts through role and context**, using Projects to maintain consistency, anonymizing student data safely, and automating common tasks."*

This is basically old news.

**Prompting to get better
answers is over.**

Prompting to make thinking *visible* is the
whole talk.

Get an account

Tonight

Claude for Teachers.

Free, Pro-level, K-12.

Verification takes days.

Free year if you verify by **June 30, 2027.**

Right now

Any free account:

- Claude
- ChatGPT
- Gemini

No paid plan. No install.

**Before you put anything
into these tools**

Two gates.

They are not the same gate.

Two gates

GATE 1

The vendor

FERPA-aligned K-12 agreement.

No training on your inputs.

Already open.

GATE 2

Your district

Whether *you* may put *that* data in *this* tool.

Only your district opens this one.

Whether and how educational data may be used in Claude for Teachers is determined by **district and state policies.**

Anthropic, clarification note – July 21, 2026

The roster key

What you send

Student A

Student B

Student C

What stays

Maps A back to the real name.

Never uploaded.

Never leaves your machine.

**What leaves your machine
should have *no identifiers* in
it.**

It's not just names

In a school of 900, each of these names one kid:

- IDs, lunch numbers, usernames, emails
- **"The student who moved here from ____ in October"**
- IEP or 504 accommodations
- The service dog. The allergy. The healthcare plan.
- `smith_john_essay_final.docx`

Strip narrative details, not just proper nouns.*

* - *this is difficult*

**Now the part I actually
came here for**

"How do I stop my students from using AI?"

- This is the wrong question.
- (They) Can't stop.
- (They) Won't stop.

Spot the thinking gap

"Write a one-page explanation of the causes of the American Revolution."

What thinking happens *before* a student types that?

Nothing.

What gets replaced

Not the essay.

Their opinion.

Not a *bad* one. A perfectly reasonable one.

All thirty of them.

The same one.

The problem isn't AI.
It's underspecified human
intent.

This next part isn't mine.

Tim Swick and Mark Davis

CSTA 2026

Didn't get their contact info at the conference, now I can't find them. Lol?

If you know them, please connect us.

Four parts

Verb

The thinking move

analyze · compare · critique

Format

What makes it visible

table · decision tree · dialogue

Voice

Whose perspective

a skeptic · a novice · a historian

Context

The human constraints

audience · purpose · limits

**"Write" is not a thinking
verb.**

**Name the cognitive move, not the
product.**

Same assignment, twice

Weak

| *"Write an essay about AI in schools."*

No verb. No format. No voice. No context.

There's no student left in it.

Rewritten

"Analyze the tradeoffs of AI in classrooms, in a two-column table, as a school administrator, focused on what a middle school must decide."

Verb · Format · Voice · Context

**Now I can grade the
prompt.**

If students are skipping these steps, they're outsourcing their thinking.

If students can't explain these four parts, they shouldn't be using AI yet.

Tim Swick & Mark Davis

Anthropic's 4D framework

- **Delegation** – what to hand over
- **Description** – what you want. **The four parts live here.**
- **Discernment** – catching "polished but thin"
- **Diligence** – using it openly

Free course → **on the repo**

Your turn

I do → we do → you do

The activity

1. An assignment they **AI'd their way through**
2. New **Project / Gem / Custom GPT**
3. Upload `framework.md`
4. Paste the **conversion prompt** + your assignment
5. Read it – then **push back on it**

github.com/parties/ai-workshop

I do

Watch me. It's recorded – you don't need to keep up.

We do

Same thing. You drive.

You do

20 minutes

Steps are on the previous slide – I'll leave them up

Three more tools, quickly

**A Project remembers who
you are.**

**It doesn't remember how
you work.**

Skills

What it is

A folder with a markdown file. **No code.**

40 lines describing my classroom.

Written once in February.

Why not today

Installing a skill runs someone else's instructions.

That's a supply chain.

Including mine.

The PII anonymizer

In development

1. Export responses as a spreadsheet
2. Run it through → names become **Student A, B, C**
3. Upload **that**, ask for feedback
4. Paste the response back → **names come back**

The roster key, automated.

All three platforms

	Claude	ChatGPT	Gemini
Free for teachers	Verify by Jun 2027	Free thru Jun 2028	Workspace
Holds context	Projects	Projects	Gems
Reusable job	Skills	Custom GPTs	Gems
Agent	Cowork	Agent Mode	—

Pick one. Learn it deeply.

What to do

Tonight

5 min – start Claude for Teachers verification.

Monday

2 min – send the district email. It's on the repo.

Monday, with kids

0 prep – four words on the board.

Verb • Format • Voice • Context

Someday

The free AI Fluency course.

